



YOU ARE **28 WEEKS AND 4 DAYS**

80 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

The sleep–wake cycle is now more established, however, just because your baby is moving, you cannot assume they are awake. They spend little time fully active with their eyes open, so many of the movements you are feeling are happening while they are asleep.

“Your baby’s growth depends on many factors and its rate varies through the course of your pregnancy.”

The growth of your baby relies on a steady stream of nutrients. Most nutrients are transferred unaltered across the placenta, but some substances are made by the placenta itself and a few are produced from scratch by your baby. These include the hormone thyroxine, the production of which depends on iodine from the mother crossing the placenta. Thyroxine has several functions and its level needs to be controlled very precisely. The placenta forms a nearly perfect barrier to thyroxine, enabling you and your baby to adjust thyroxine levels independently of each other.

In the early stages of pregnancy, genetic factors largely determined the size of your baby, but by now environmental factors are becoming more important. Overall, your baby’s final birthweight is determined about 40 percent by genetic factors and 60 percent by environmental factors. Your baby grows at a steady rate from 24 weeks until the last 2–3 weeks, when growth continues but more slowly. (If you’re expecting twins, your babies grow as if alone in the uterus up until 28 weeks but from this point there is a reduction in their growth rate.) Your baby’s internal organs account for much of his current growth

The liver and brain, in particular, continue to enlarge and muscle mass increases. Later, fat will be deposited under the skin, rounding out your baby’s contours.

IDENTICAL TWINS

The incidence of identical twins has been stable for some years. Identical twins represent about a third of all twin pregnancies, regardless of race, maternal age, or geography.

FOCUS ON TWINS

The clothes you buy for your twins should be easy to put on and take off, and, of course, machine washable. You’ll probably be given outfits as presents, so just buy the basics.

For each baby, you’re likely to need at least::

- Six undershirts
- Six onesies